

Day 5 — Final Artifact

Presentations + Course Closure

Activity packet for participant quads. Today every quad presents their capstone. The cohort scores. The course closes.

Where we are in the week

8 weeks of muscle. 5 days of capstone work. Today is the proof.

Inputs you bring

- The full 6-document artifact set (PRD-light / TCD-light / TMD-light / SEP-light / DP-light / AI Spec v2)
- A presentation deck (slides or live walkthrough)
- All three quad voices ready to speak

What you'll produce today

- A **15-minute presented capstone**
- **Cohort + instructor scores** on the rubric
- A **personal reflection**: 2 muscles to deepen + 1 habit to retire
- **Post-assessment** (Product Management + Data Literacy) submitted

The Friday rubric (review before presenting)

Each quad's 15-min presentation is scored on:

Dimension	Weight	Exemplary
Customer + problem clarity	15%	Engineer or stakeholder could understand the customer's pain in 90 seconds
Integrated artifact set	15%	All 6 artifacts referenced; references are consistent
AI Spec quality	20%	Engineering-ready; integrates PRD/TCD/TMD outputs; provenance log included
Trade-off honesty	15%	At least 2 trade-offs named with cost + revisit trigger
Outcome thinking	10%	NS / Tier-Sheet / leading indicator vocabulary used naturally
Delivery readiness	10%	DP-light shows backlog, tracking, one bottleneck experiment
Presentation craft	15%	All quad voices speak; time-managed; questions answered with curiosity not defensiveness

Score 0–4 per dimension. Apply weights for total /4.0. Same convention as prior weeks.

Each cohort member scores every quad (peer scores). Instructor scores separately. Final score = (peer mean + instructor) / 2.

Activity 1 — Final Tweaks + Presentation Order

Format: Quad • 30 min • Block 1 (truncated)

Purpose

Last-minute polish. Decide presentation order. Anticipate Q&A.

Quad protocol

1. **One last run-through** (15 min). With timer.
2. **Predict the 3 most likely Q&A questions** (10 min). For each: who answers? What's the response?
3. **Pin the 6 documents on the wall / share digitally** (5 min). Easier for cohort to skim during presentation.

The instructor sets the presentation order at 09:00.

Activity 2 — Presentations (block 2 + 3 + early block 4)

Format: Cohort + instructors • 20 min per quad

The 15 + 5 split

- **15 minutes presentation** (timer enforced)
- **5 minutes Q&A** (instructors lead; cohort members raise hands)

Cohort scoring discipline

- Score on the rubric while listening — not afterwards (memory degrades)
- Specific notes per dimension help the post-presentation feedback
- Use whole-number scores (no half-points)
- Don't "grade on a curve" — score against the rubric, not against other quads

Q&A discipline (for presenters)

When asked	Do this
A specific question you can answer	Answer crisply (< 90 sec)
A specific question you can't answer	"Honestly, I don't know — here's what we'd do to find out"
A challenge to a decision	Restate the decision; restate the trade-off; offer the revisit trigger
A question about something that wasn't in scope	Acknowledge; reference your non-goals (PRD-light §3) / DP-light "explicitly NOT"
A hostile question	Curiosity, not defense. "What concern would that addresses?"

The Q&A is part of the rubric (presentation craft). Quads who handle Q&A with curiosity, not defensiveness, score high.

Activity 3 — Cohort Retrospective

Format: Cohort + instructors • **30 min** • Block 4 first half

Purpose

What worked across the cohort? What should the next academy deepen?

Structure

Three rounds, each 7–10 minutes:

Round 1 — What surprised you about the academy?

Each participant shares one thing that surprised them — content, process, themselves.

Round 2 — What muscles are you keeping?

Each participant declares 2 muscles they'll continue deepening:

- "I'm keeping the access-pattern-first discipline for data modeling"
- "I'm keeping the 'engage early' principle from stakeholder work"
- "I'm keeping AI-validation logs for any AI-assisted spec work"

Round 3 — What habit are you retiring?

Each participant declares 1 habit to leave behind:

- "I'm retiring 'output ≠ outcome' confusion in sprint reviews"
- "I'm retiring the rookie 'because Netflix' microservices argument"
- "I'm retiring stakeholder maps that are just org charts"

Output

Three artifact lists (surprises / keeping / retiring) the cohort takes with them.

Activity 4 — Course Closure

Format: Cohort + instructors • **45 min** • Block 4 second half

Components

1. **Post-assessments** (15 min): Product Management + Data Literacy. Same instruments as the pre-assessments at the start of Week 1.
2. **Certificate distribution** (5 min): quad photo if appropriate.
3. **Closing words from instructors** (10 min): summative remarks.
4. **Final round-robin** (15 min): each participant says **one sentence** about what the academy gave them.

The final round-robin is the closure ritual. It's brief, public, and important.

Materials handed out

- Personal copies of all artifact templates (for use post-academy)
- The Pattern Library (cumulative across Weeks 2–8)
- A "next 90 days" reading list (3–5 books / podcasts / talks)
- Contact info for the cohort (if the cohort wants to stay in touch)

End-of-academy checkpoint

Each participant ends the academy with:

- ✓ **Capstone artifact set** (6 documents) for Holocron
- ✓ **Final presentation score** (peer + instructor)
- ✓ **Reflection list**: 2 muscles to deepen + 1 habit to retire
- ✓ **Post-assessments** submitted
- ✓ **Pattern Library** + artifact templates for use in their next role
- ✓ **Cohort connections** for ongoing support